

Enforcing Mandatory Fields Using UI Policies and Migrating Changes with Update Sets

Problem Statement:

In many organizations, data entered into systems is often incomplete or inconsistent due to the lack of enforced mandatory fields at the user interface level. This leads to poor data quality, workflow interruptions, and reporting inaccuracies. Additionally, changes made in development environments (such as UI policies) are not always properly migrated to testing or production environments, causing inconsistencies across instances. There is a need to enforce mandatory data entry dynamically and ensure seamless migration of configurations across environments.

Project Objective :

The primary objective of this project is to improve data accuracy and consistency within the ServiceNow platform by enforcing mandatory fields dynamically using UI Policies. This ensures that users provide all required information based on specific conditions, reducing incomplete or incorrect data entry. Additionally, the project aims to establish a reliable and structured process for migrating these configurations across different environments using Update Sets, ensuring that all changes made in the development instance are accurately reflected in testing and production. By doing so, the project enhances system efficiency, minimizes errors, and supports seamless workflow execution across the organization.

Skills Required:

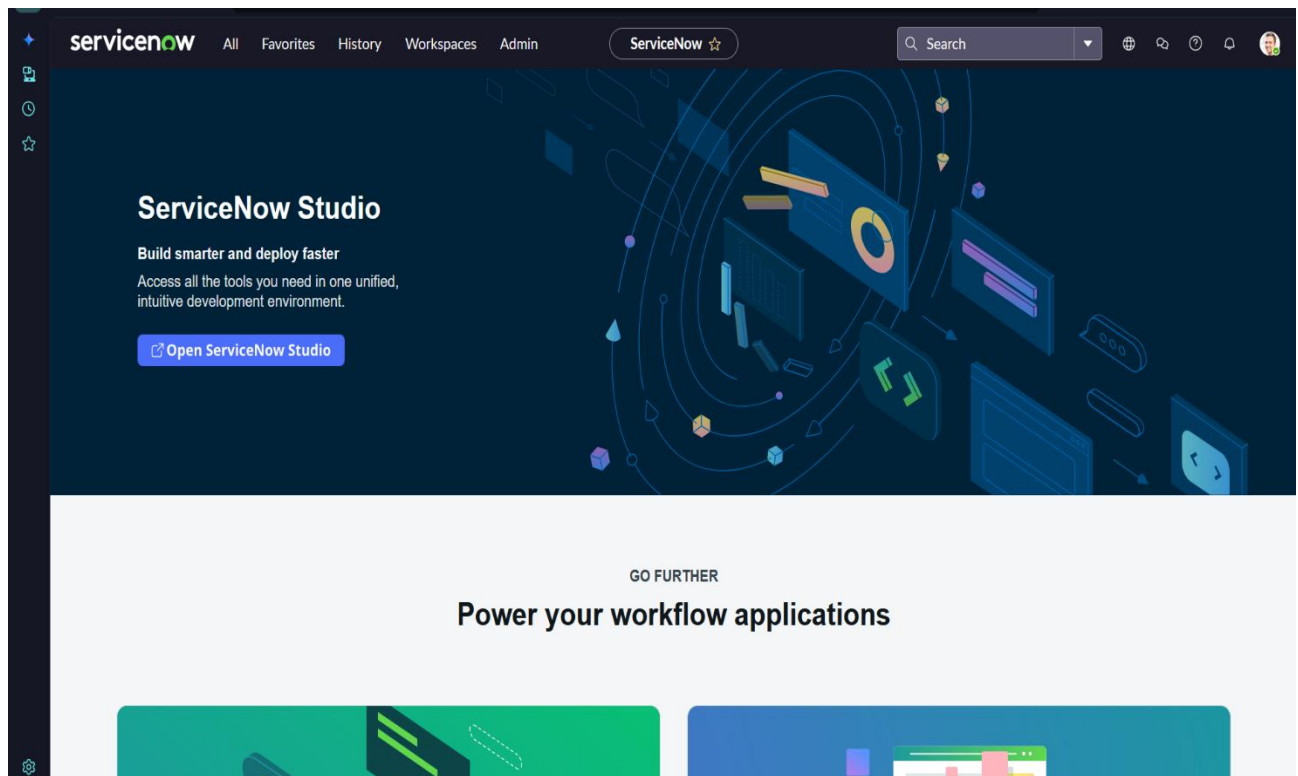
- Basic understanding of ServiceNow platform
- Knowledge of UI Policies and UI Policy Actions
- Understanding of Update Sets and migration process
- Familiarity with form design and field configuration
- Basic scripting knowledge (JavaScript for advanced UI policies)
- Testing and debugging skills
- Understanding of ITSM workflows (optional but helpful)

Task Initiation:

Step 1: Requirement Analysis

Create Update Set

1. Open service now.



2. Click on All >> search for Update Sets

servicenow All Favorites History Workspaces Admin Update Sets

Search

Update Sets Name Search

All

Name	Application	State	Installed from	Created	Created by	Parent	Batch Base
Default	Pipeline	In progress		2026-03-29 20:00:01	admin	(empty)	(empty)
Default	Global	In progress		2025-12-08 03:03:51	system	(empty)	(empty)
Default	Security Center	In progress		2025-12-08 04:12:23	system	(empty)	(empty)
UI Policy for Mandatory Priority	Global	Complete		2026-03-31 23:21:45	admin	(empty)	(empty)
UI Policy for Mandatory Priority	Global	Complete		2026-03-31 23:12:35	admin	(empty)	(empty)

Related Links

[Merge Update Sets](#)

1 to 5 of 5

3. Select Local Update Sets

servicenow All Favorites History Workspaces Admin Update Set - UI Policy for Mandatory Priority

Application scope: Global
Update set: UI Policy for Mandatory Priority

Update Set - UI Policy for Mandatory Priority

Name: UI Policy for Mandatory Priority
State: In progress
Application: Global
Created: 2025-02-02 22:18:48
Created by: admin
Merged to:
Release date:
Install date:
Installed from:
Description: Making the Priority field mandatory when State is In Progress

Update

Related Links

[Merge With Another Update Set](#)
[Scan Update Set](#)
[ISN Utility Versions \(0\)](#)

Customer Updates (2) Update Set Logs Child Update Sets

Created	Type	View	Target name	Updated by	Remote update set	Action
2025-02-02 22:24:48	UI Policy Action		priority	admin	(empty)	INSERT_OR_UPDATE
2025-02-02 22:24:48	UI Policy		Mandatory Distribution In Progress	admin	(empty)	INSERT_OR_UPDATE

4. Click on new

5. Fill the details below and make current.

UI policy

Step 2: Create UI Policy

1. Open service now.
2. Click on All >> search for ui policies
3. Navigate to System UI >> UI Policies
4. Click on new

The screenshot shows the ServiceNow 'UI Policy - Mandatory Priority when In Progress' form. The browser address bar shows the URL: https://dev224572.service-now.com/now/nav/ui/classic/params/target/sys_ui_policy.do%3Fsys_id%3D97fdb414c30c0310841b9a2ed40131b0%26sysparm_r...

UI Policy - Mandatory Priority when In Progress

UI policies change fields on a form based on a set of conditions. Use UI policies to show or hide fields, or to make fields mandatory or read-only based on these conditions. A UI policy specifies one or more actions to take when the policy is triggered. First, create the policy. Then add as many actions as necessary. UI policy actions are applied only if all of the following conditions are met:

- The UI Policy is **Active**
- The items in the **Conditions** field evaluate to true
- The field specified in the UI policy action is present on the specified form

[More info](#)

Table: Incident [incident] Application: Global

Active: ☒

* Short description: Mandatory Priority when In Progress

When to Apply

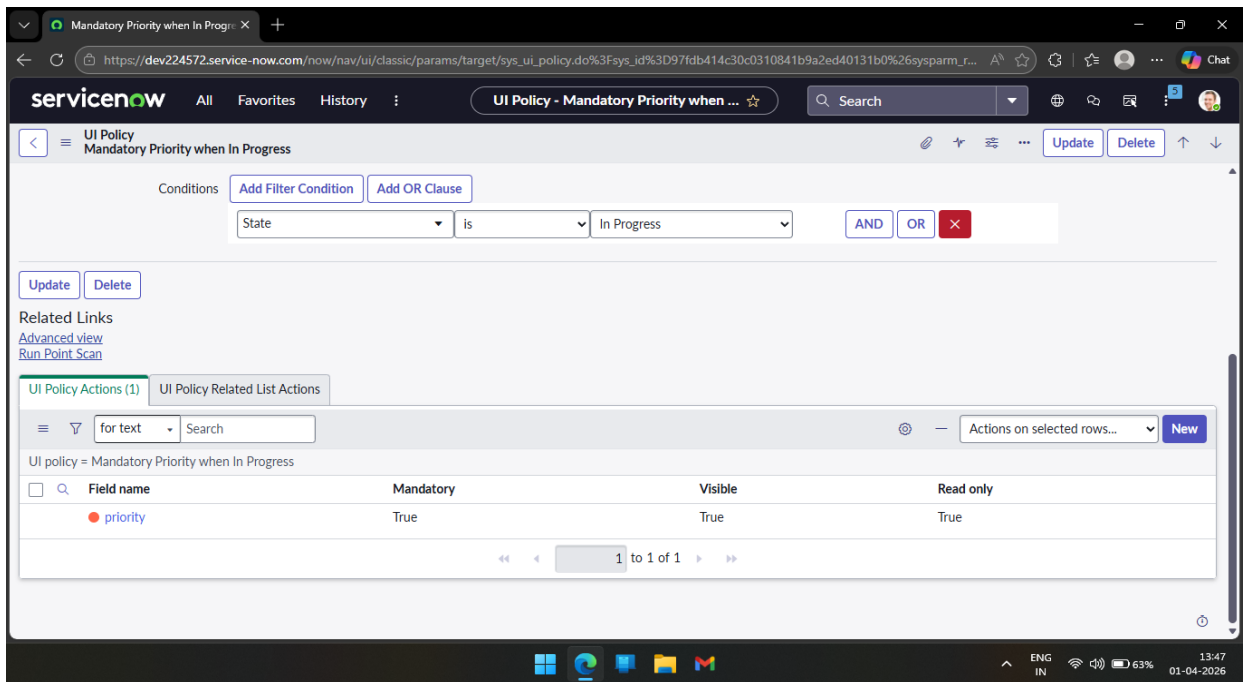
Conditions: [Add Filter Condition](#) [Add OR Clause](#)

State is In Progress [AND](#) [OR](#) [X](#)

[Update](#) [Delete](#)

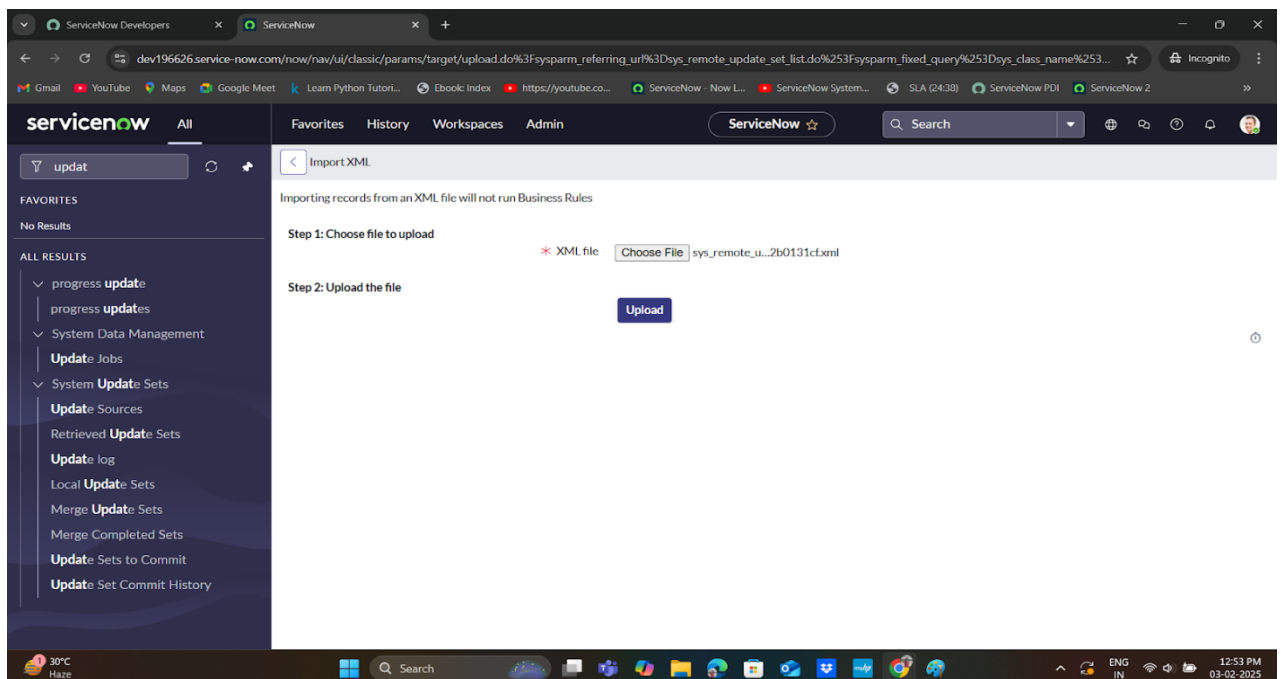
Related Links

5. Fill the following details and Save
6. Scroll Down and add 'priority' Field on Ui policy Actions
7. Click on submit.



Step 3: Configure UI Policy Actions

- Select the fields to enforce.
- Mark fields as mandatory, visible, or read-only as needed.



Step 4: Test UI Policy

- Validate behavior in the development instance.
- Check different scenarios and edge cases.

Step 5: Create Update Set

- Capture all changes in an Update Set.
- Ensure all related configurations are included.

Step 6: Check Update Set

1. Navigate to the System Update Sets > Local Update Sets.
2. Open the 'Ui policy for mandatory priority' Update Set.
3. Verify that your UI Policy and UI Policy Action are listed.

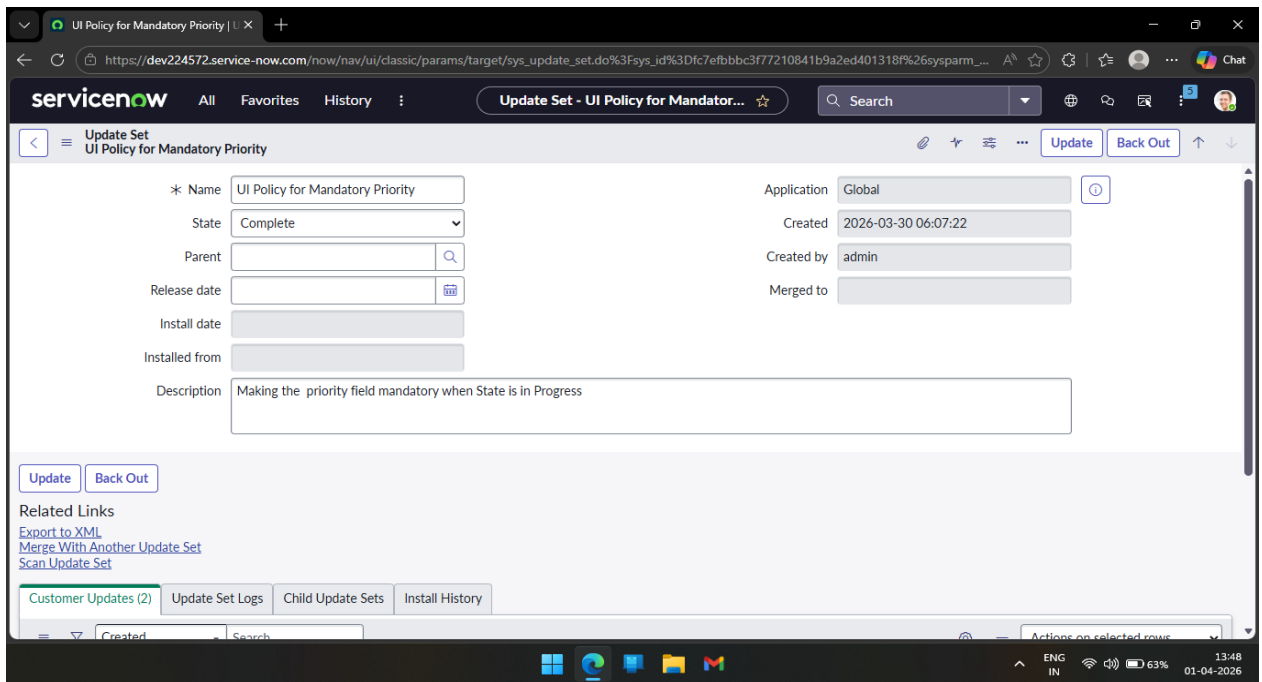
Step 7: Export and Import the Update Set

1. Set State to Complete and Click Export to XML on the Update Set record.

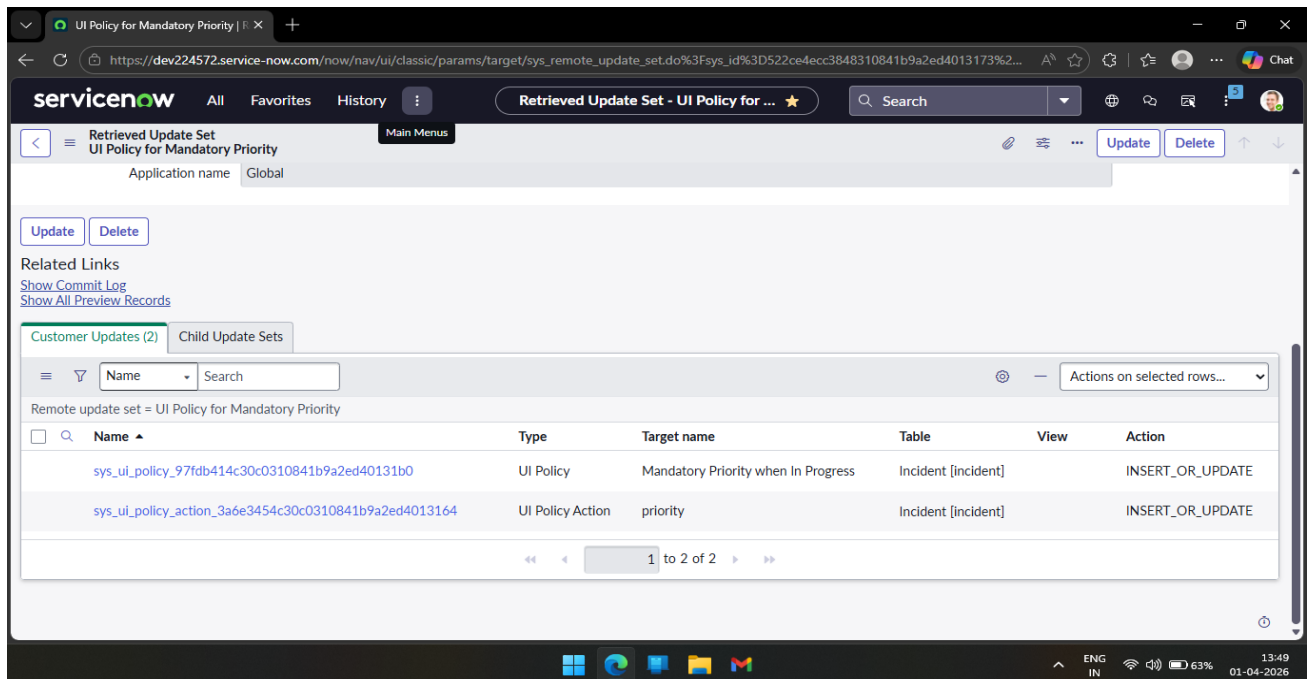
The screenshot displays the ServiceNow interface for 'Retrieved Update Sets'. The table lists the following data:

Name	Application	State	Update source	Description	Loaded	Committed	Parent	Remote Batch Base
UI Policy for Mandatory Priority	Global	Committed	(empty)	Making the priority field mandatory whe...	2026-03-31 22:42:11	2026-03-31 22:44:48	(empty)	(empty)

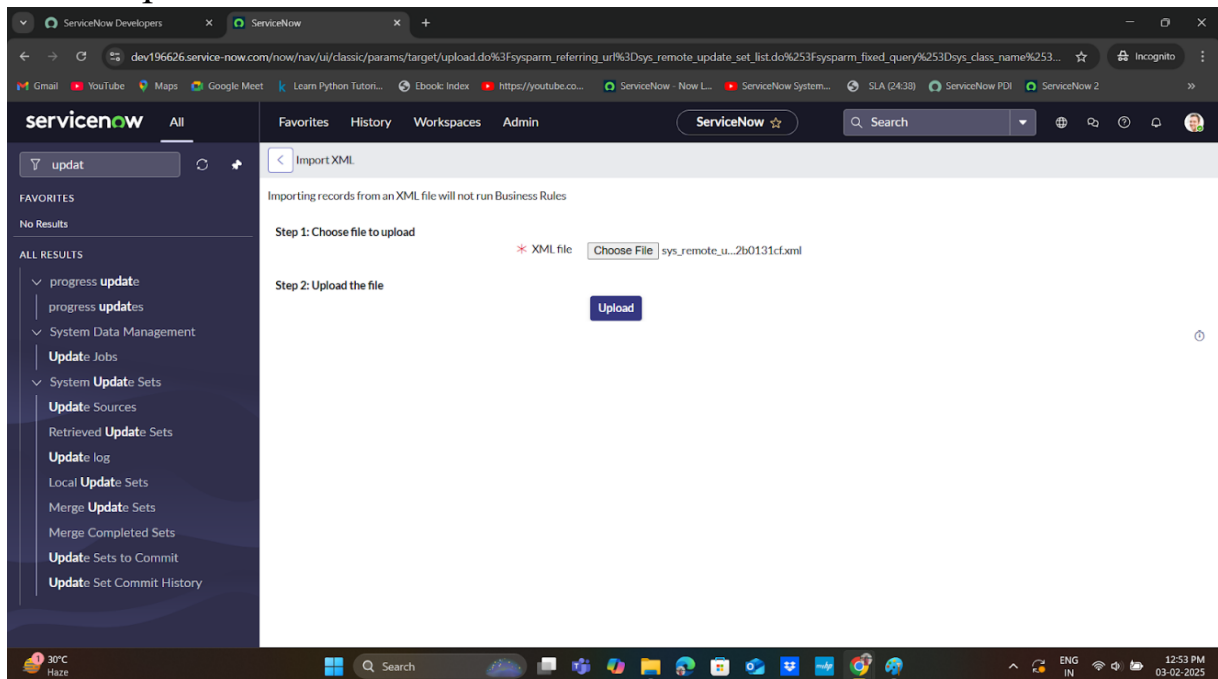
Below the table, there is a 'Related Links' section with the link: [Import Update Set from XML](#).



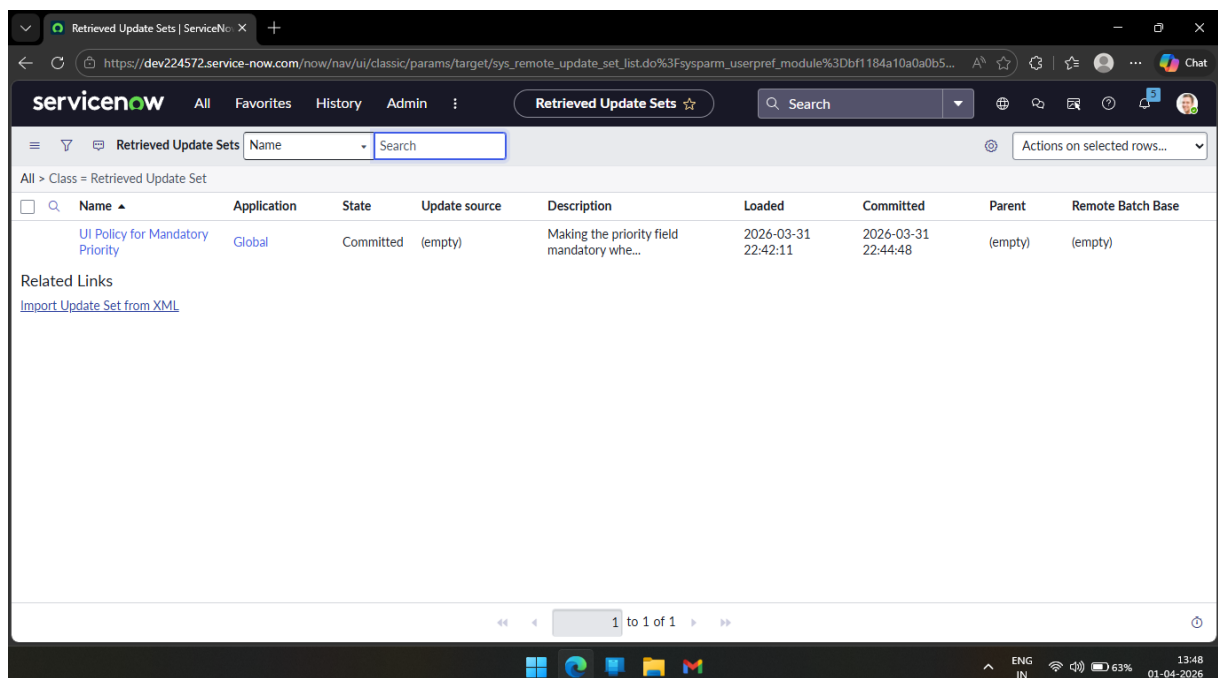
2. Download the XML file.
3. Now Open Another Instance to Export Update Set.
4. Go to System Update Sets >> Retrieved Update Sets.



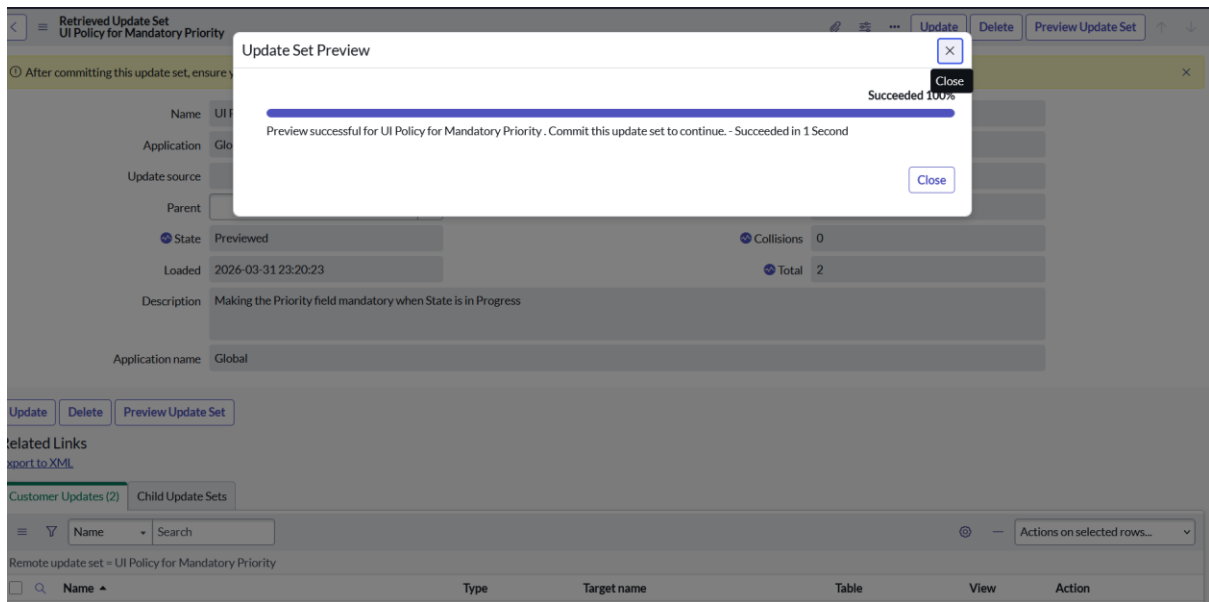
5. Click on the Import update set from XML and Select File and Upload



6. Open the update set that you have created in your instance here.



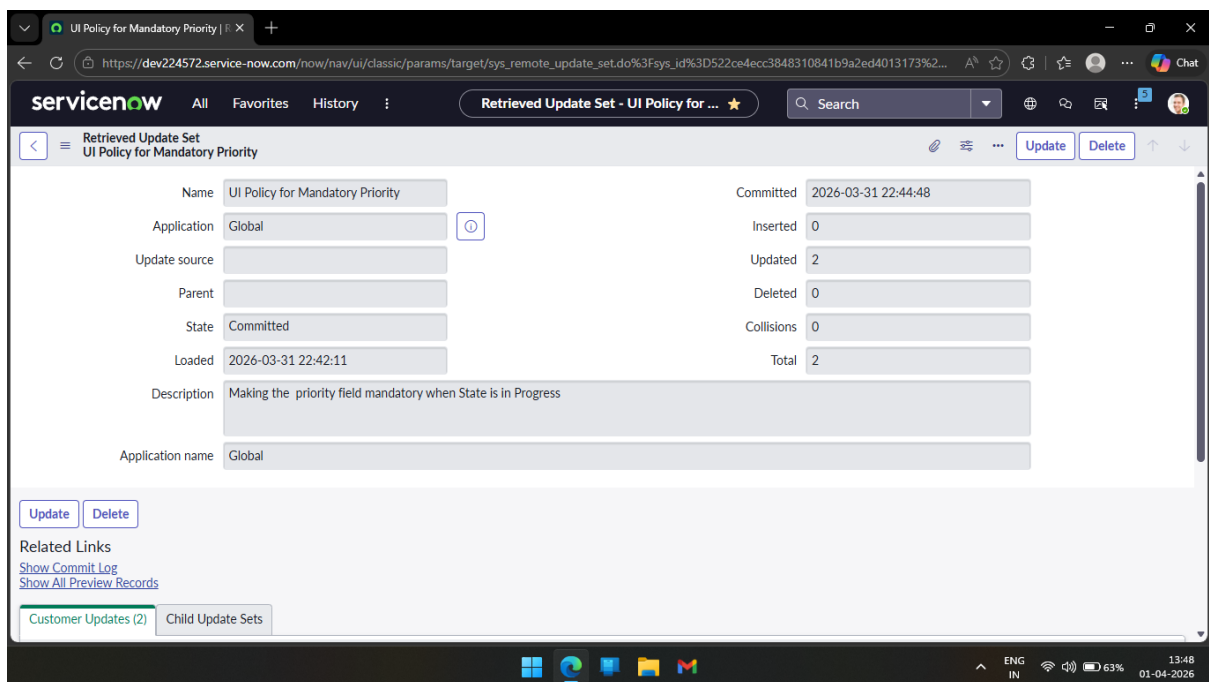
7. Preview the Update Set.



8. Commit the Update Set.

Testing Incident

1. Go to the incident module.
2. Open an existing incident or create a new one.
3. Change the State is In-progress



4.The Priority field should now be mandatory

The screenshot displays the ServiceNow Incident form for incident INC0010001. The form is divided into two main sections: a left-hand form area and a right-hand field area. The left-hand form area includes fields for Number (INC0010001), Caller (Gopi krishnan), Category (Inquiry / Help), Subcategory (-- None --), Service, Service offering, Configuration item, and a Short description (new task is created). The right-hand field area includes Channel (-- None --), State (In Progress), Impact (3 - Low), Urgency (3 - Low), Priority (5 - Planning), Assignment group, and Assigned to (Gowtham). The Priority field is highlighted with a red asterisk, indicating it is mandatory. Below the form fields, there is a 'Related Search Results' section and a 'Notes' section with a 'Work notes' list.

Conclusion

This project effectively demonstrates the use of UI Policies to enforce business rules in a dynamic and configuration-driven manner, eliminating the need for custom scripting and preserving platform stability. By enforcing the Priority field as mandatory when an incident transitions to the *In Progress* state, the solution ensures data completeness at a critical point in the incident lifecycle, leading to better prioritization, improved operational visibility, and more consistent workflow execution. In addition, the use of Update Sets to capture, review, and migrate all configuration changes highlights best practices for controlled deployment and environment management in ServiceNow. Together, these practices showcase a scalable, upgrade-safe approach to form behaviour control and configuration governance that can be reliably applied across multiple instances.